1) The Government of Pakistan submits requests for reimbursement for costs incurred in the Global War on Terror to the Office of the Defense Representative at the U.S. Embassy in Islamabad, which is responsible for verifying that the claim is based on quantifiable information provided by the Government of Pakistan;
2) CENTCOM is responsible for verifying that Pakistan's claims support the objectives of the Global War on Terror and U.S. military operations, and that costs would not have otherwise been incurred by Pakistan;
3) Following CENTCOM's verification, the Department of Defense Comptroller evaluates CSF claims for credibility and reasonableness.

Once these actions have been completed, the Department of Defense sends the CSF reimbursement request to the Department of State for the Secretary of State concurrence. Acting on the Secretary's behalf, the Bureau of Political-Military Affairs coordinates with the Bureau of South and Central Asian Affairs (SCA) and the Office of the Director of U.S. Foreign Assistance (F) to ensure that CSF payments are consistent with foreign policy objectives for Pakistan and the region. For Pakistan, these objectives include establishing stability throughout the country, particularly on the border with Afghanistan, and improving Pakistan's capability to provide border security and conduct counterinsurgency and counterterrorism operations.

Regional objectives include bolstering institutions that provide security; countering extremism; combating the drug trade; and improving peace and stability by building the political and popular will against terrorism. After SCA and F Bureaus provide clearance, PM Bureau transmits Department of State concurrence on the CSF reimbursements to the Department of Defense. The Department of State maintains a close relationship with the Department of Defense, and we ensure that any concerns identified during our review process are dealt with effectively through the interagency coordination process.

Pakistan is on the front lines in the Global War on Terror. More than ever, our national security is linked to the success, security, and stability of a democratic Pakistan. The CSF program is a key tool for enabling the Government of Pakistan's contribution to our common struggle against violent extremists, particularly in Pakistan's frontier areas. The Department is supportive of the CSF program, which helps to ensure that Pakistan and other nations have the capacity to conduct the sort of long-term, aggressive, and comprehensive campaigns required to guarantee the safety of American lives.

This concludes my formal remarks. Thank you for your time and attention. I would be happy to take any questions you might have.

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